IT CONSULTANT CHALLENGE 2026 · ROUND 1

Keeping the delivery promise across three markets

A fulfilment control layer on top of Company A’s existing systems in Denmark, Norway and Sweden

THE ANSWER ON ONE PAGE

Problem	Order, stock, supplier and transport data sit in separate systems, so a late or incomplete delivery is usually discovered only when the truck arrives.
Solution	One shared layer reads those systems, joins every order into one timeline, flags orders at risk and alerts staff and customers early. No existing system is replaced.
MVP	Sweden, 20 pilot stores, 12 weeks, read-only. Then Denmark and Norway with their own adapters.
Impact	About EUR 135k a year in the pilot and about EUR 2M a year at group scale; payback within 6 months of full rollout (assumed figures, see slide 10).

Team Old Men

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THE REAL PROBLEM

All four challenges end in one place: the delivery

ROOT CAUSE

Fragmented systems

Order, stock, supplier and transport data live in different systems

SO

No one sees the whole order

No single system can tell whether every part will be ready on time

SO

Manual chasing

Staff check several systems and phone colleagues and carriers

SO

Inconsistent handling

Each store deals with late orders in its own way

RESULT

Broken delivery promise

Late or incomplete delivery; the customer finds out first

Fulfilment is where all four challenges meet, and the only one the customer feels directly. Making every order visible across systems breaks the chain without replacing them.

WHO IS HURT AND HOW

Construction customers

A crew of four waiting for a missing delivery loses about EUR 1,500 in a day (assumed). This is what makes professional customers switch to a competitor.

Store and distribution staff

Every “where is my order?” call means searching several systems. Problems are found when it is too late to fix them.

Management

No shared view of delivery performance across stores and countries, so what works in one market cannot be repeated in the others.

WHERE TO FOCUS FIRST

Fulfilment scores highest on impact and on speed to results

Challenge	Business impact	Felt by customers	Results within ~3 months	Helps the other challenges	Score	Our verdict
Fragmented systems	●●●	●○○	●○○	●●●	8 / 12	Root cause, but replacing systems takes years. Our layer starts reducing it.
Manual processes	●●●	●○○	●●○	●●○	8 / 12	Big internal cost, but different in each country. Our layer removes the status chasing.
Inconsistent operations	●●○	●●○	●○○	●○○	6 / 12	Mainly a process-change task; hard to measure quickly.
Delivery and fulfilment	●●●	●●●	●●●	●●●	**12 / 12**	**Prioritised:** works on top of existing systems and touches all four.

Scored 1–3 by our team from the brief and our assumptions. “Results within ~3 months” means an MVP can show measurable results without replacing any system.

ONE SOLUTION, A BENEFIT FOR EACH MARKET’S OWN PRIORITY

Sweden

Top priority: delivery and fulfilment

Fewer late and incomplete deliveries; customers warned early.

Denmark

Top priority: manual processes

No more searching several systems to answer “where is my order?”.

Norway

Top priority: store operations

Every store handles problem orders the same way, from one task list.

KEY ASSUMPTIONS

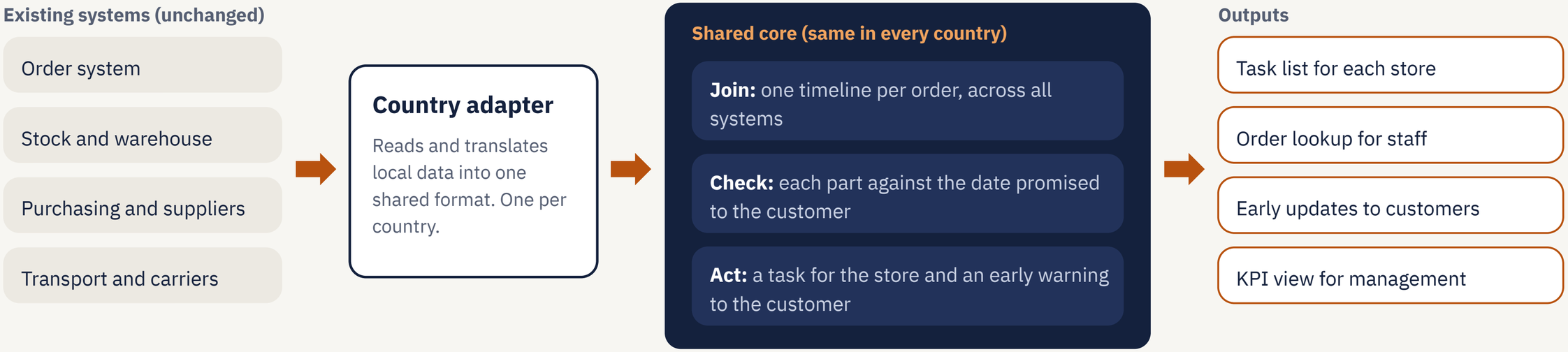
We state, justify and test every assumption

Assumption	Why it is reasonable	How we check it in weeks 1–3
One order is often fulfilled from several sources: store, central warehouse, supplier	Building materials are bulky and varied; the brief names store and distribution operations separately	Sample 500 recent orders and count the sources per order
Order, stock, purchasing and transport data sit in separate systems	Each country built its own systems over time (brief)	Map the Swedish systems with local IT
About 10% of deliveries are late, incomplete or failed today	Typical for bulky deliveries from several sources	Measure from 12 months of delivery history
About 60% of those problems start before the truck leaves: missing stock, late supplier, picking not done	A delivery can only leave on time if every part is ready	Classify the causes of last quarter’s problem deliveries
Every system can at least export its data (API, database or file export)	Standard for retail order and finance systems	Technical check of each source system
Sweden feels fulfilment pain the most	The brief’s own example; long distances and heavy use of external carriers	Compare delivery figures across the three countries

All figures in this deck are illustrative assumptions. Weeks 1–3 of the MVP replace them with measured values before any target is fixed.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

A control layer that joins, checks and acts



One strategic solution: the same order model, risk rules and screens in every market.

Not one identical implementation: own adapter per country; cut-off times, delivery windows, language and channels are settings.

WHY NOT SOMETHING BIGGER FIRST?

Replace all systems

Takes years; conflicts with “time to market is critical”.

Connect systems to each other

Connections multiply; still no single view of an order.

Data warehouse and reports

Shows problems after they happen; nobody is told to act.

Full order management system

Changes systems and processes in all countries at once.

HOW IT WORKS: ONE ORDER

Order 1001: found on Monday, not on Wednesday

A construction customer’s order is promised for **Wednesday**. Today is **Monday**.

Line	Product	Source system	Status	Check
A	50 bags of cement	Store stock	Picked	On track
B	20 steel bars	Central warehouse	Not yet picked	Watch: pick by Tue 14:00
C	Concrete mixer	Supplier	Confirmed for Thursday	**At risk: 1 day late**

Each line lives in a different system. Only the joined timeline shows the conflict.

What the layer does on Monday

1. Opens a task for the store’s delivery coordinator: “Line C is one day late”.
2. Suggests a fix with a simple rule: deliver A and B on Wednesday, C on Thursday.
3. Once the coordinator confirms, texts the customer the new plan in Swedish.

WITHOUT THE LAYER

Wednesday morning the truck arrives without the mixer. The crew waits, the customer calls the store, and staff search four systems to find out why.

WITH THE LAYER

Two days to act. The customer re-plans the crew around Thursday, nobody waits on site, and the store avoids a failed delivery.

WHERE AI CREATES VALUE

AI only where fixed rules fall short

AI use	What it does	Why fixed rules are not enough	Phase
Read supplier messages	Pulls confirmed dates and quantities from supplier emails and PDF confirmations	Every supplier writes differently; today staff read and type these by hand	**MVP**
Data-mapping assistant	Suggests how each country’s fields and status codes map to the shared order model	Mapping is the slowest part of each country rollout; engineers approve every mapping	**MVP (internal)**
Delay-risk prediction	Learns which suppliers, products and periods run late even when status looks fine	Rules only see problems that are already visible	After pilot
Smarter fix suggestions	Weighs stock in nearby stores, distance and customer priority	Too many combinations to write as fixed rules	Later
Customer replies	Answers “where is my order?” by chat or email in Danish, Norwegian and Swedish	Questions vary too much for fixed answers	Later

GUARDRAILS

The MVP works without AI: the risk checks are plain rules. AI runs on EU-hosted models under GDPR; results with low confidence go to a person. Customer messages use only facts from the order timeline, so AI never invents a delivery date.

MVP SCOPE

One market, read-only, 12 weeks

In scope

- Sweden, 20 pilot stores
- One adapter: order, stock, purchasing and transport data
- Shared order model and rule-based risk checks
- Task list and order lookup for store staff
- Delay updates to customers by SMS (fixed templates)
- AI: reading supplier messages, data-mapping assistant

Not in the MVP

- Writing back into existing systems
- Replacing any existing system
- Denmark and Norway (phase 2)
- Live driver tracking
- AI delay prediction (after the pilot)

12-WEEK PLAN

Weeks 1–3
Map Swedish systems, check assumptions, measure the baseline

Weeks 4–7
Build the adapter, order model and risk rules

Weeks 8–10
Staff screens and alerts; test in 2 stores

Weeks 11–12
Live in 20 stores; compare with the baseline

Team and cost (assumed)
6 people: product owner, 2 developers, integration engineer, UX designer (part-time) and a Swedish store-operations lead. About **EUR 250k**.

Go / no-go for Denmark and Norway after week 12
≥ 60% of problem deliveries flagged at least a day ahead · staff in pilot stores use the task list every day · data matches the source systems in ≥ 98% of checked orders

ROLLOUT ACROSS MARKETS

One core, adapted to each country

Phase 1 · months 1–3

Sweden pilot

Prove the impact where fulfilment hurts most. Store staff co-design the screens.

Phase 2 · months 4–9

Denmark and Norway

New adapters and local settings, store by store. Denmark: less manual chasing. Norway: one way for every store to handle problem orders.

Phase 3 · month 10 onwards

All markets

AI delay prediction, smarter fix suggestions, and write-back into existing systems.

Why Sweden first, not the home market Denmark?

Fulfilment hurts most in Sweden, so the effect is clearest to measure. A smaller pilot also keeps early mistakes away from the largest market.

Who acts on the alerts?

Each store’s delivery coordinator owns its task list and handles alerts the same working day. A central team of 3–4 owns the rules, settings and KPIs for all countries.

KEY RISKS AND HOW WE HANDLE THEM

Poor or inconsistent data

Data checks in every adapter; the pilot validates the order model first.

Old systems without APIs

Hourly or daily file exports instead; still far better than today.

Staff do not adopt it

No extra data entry; it replaces searching. 1-hour training and a super-user per store.

Too many alerts

Start with a few rules; tune thresholds weekly with the pilot stores.

MEASURABLE BUSINESS IMPACT

Small pilot to prove it, large value at scale

SWEDEN PILOT · 20 STORES · PER YEAR

1,200 fewer problem deliveries, about EUR 120k saved

400 h of staff time freed from status calls, about EUR 16k

Where 30% comes from: 4,000 problem deliveries × 60% start before dispatch × half can be fixed when flagged a day ahead = 1,200.

GROUP SCALE · ~300 STORES · THREE COUNTRIES

€2.0M benefit a year: the pilot result × 15

Investment: about EUR 750k (MVP 250k + rollout 500k), plus about EUR 150k a year to run.

Payback: within 6 months of full rollout. The pilot alone is not meant to pay back; it proves the numbers.

Not counted: sales kept from professional customers who no longer switch to a competitor.

KPI	Baseline	Pilot target
On-time and complete delivery rate	90% (assumed)	93%
Problem deliveries flagged at least one day ahead	≈ 0% today	60% or more
“Where is my order?” contacts	10,000 a year (assumed)	−50%

Assumed: 40,000 deliveries a year in the pilot, 10% problem rate, EUR 100 per problem delivery, 5 minutes per status call, EUR 40 per staff hour.